

The Couples series — one door per addiction

Started 12 Aug 2026. Every piece is the same shape: **a couple, one of them using, and the story told from the side of the one who found out.**

Why this is the door-opener

Every recovery app in KEYWORDS.md assumes the same couple — a man with a problem and a wife who found out. So every other version of that sentence is unclaimed, which is why the cheapest terms in the entire keyword file sit in this lane.

Each episode opens a door nobody else is standing in:

#	Couple	Addiction	Door it opens
1	Two men	Gambling	Same-sex male couples · the only addiction with no physical tell
2	Two women	Shopping	Same-sex female couples · 880/mo, KD 41 — a Build term, not too hard
~~3~~	~~Man + woman, flipped~~	~~Food / binge~~	DROPPED by Jacques, 12 Aug 2026 — do not re-pitch it. The lane is still served by the /how-to-stop-binge-eating page, which is live and targets the 9,900/mo term. What was given up is the video, not the search.
—	Young couple	Doomscrolling	BENCHED

The rule that makes the series work: the person using is never the villain and never forgiven. Every episode has one line that says *they're not a bad person* and one that says *that's what makes it hard*. That pair is what every partner recognizes and what no advert ever says.

■ Generate everything before 25 August

Manus's advanced models are free until **25 Aug 2026**. That is the whole series — **30 images** — for nothing, and it does all ten at once without the face drifting.

So bank all four episodes now, even the ones you won't post until October. Images keep. A free window doesn't. This is the cheapest the artwork will ever be, and after the 25th every one of these costs money.

Order to generate in, if the window gets tight: **Episode 2 first** (its search term is the one that's actually winnable — shopping addiction help, 880/mo at difficulty 41), then 3, then 1. **Episode 3 is dropped** — see the table above.

House look — paste at the end of EVERY image prompt

*cinematic photograph, shot on 35mm, shallow depth of field, warm practical
light from lamps and screens only, muted color grade, documentary realism,
vertical 9:16 composition, ordinary American apartment, no text in the image*

Keep each couple's descriptions **identical in every prompt** or the faces drift between shots.

EPISODE 1 · The Gambler — two men

DANNY: Black man, late 30s, short locs, lean, glasses.

MARCUS: white man, early 40s, close-cropped greying hair, heavier build, beard.

Gambling has no tell. No smell, no slurring, nothing in the bin. Every other addiction announces itself on the body; this one only ever shows up in **the money** — which is why the discovery happens in a banking app, and why the partner is always last to know. Build the whole piece on that.

SHOT 1 — DANNY and MARCUS on a sofa in a lamplit living room at night, sitting close, both looking at their own phones, comfortable, nothing wrong *"Nothing looked wrong."*

SHOT 2 — Close on DANNY's hands holding a phone showing a banking app, the screen the only light on his face, his expression going still *"I was only checking the balance."*

SHOT 3 — Extreme close on a phone screen showing a long list of identical repeated transactions, slightly blurred, the repetition obvious, a thumb frozen mid-scroll *"The same charge. Over and over."*

SHOT 4 — DANNY looking up from the phone across the room at MARCUS, who is laughing at something on TV and hasn't noticed, the space between them wide *"He was laughing at something on TV."*

SHOT 5 — DANNY alone at a kitchen table late at night, laptop open, bank statements spread out, a pen in his hand, adding it up *"So I added it up. All of it."*

SHOT 6 — Close on a printed savings account statement on a kitchen table under a lamp, the balance column low, a coffee ring on the corner *"Four years of saving."*

SHOT 7 — A framed photograph on a shelf of DANNY and MARCUS together somewhere happy, slightly out of focus, foreground dark *"He's not a bad man."*

SHOT 8 — MARCUS asleep in bed in the dark, DANNY sitting up beside him awake, looking straight ahead at nothing *"That's what makes it hard."*

SHOT 9 — DANNY on the sofa at first light, gray morning through the window, phone in his hand, searching for something, face tired *"I didn't know who to ask."*

SHOT 10 — Wide of the same living room in full morning light, both men sitting on the sofa turned toward each other, mid-conversation, nothing resolved but the talking started *"So I started with the truth."*

YouTube: When you find out where the money's been going **TikTok:** He was laughing at the TV. I was looking at four years of savings.

1. 01_sofa	Still	5.0s	cut	Nothing looked wrong.
2. 02_phone	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I was only checking the balance.
3. 03_screen	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	The same charge. Over and over.
4. 04_lookup	Still	5.0s	cut	He was laughing at something on TV.
5. 05_kitchen	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	So I added it up. All of it.
6. 06_savings	Still	5.0s	cut	Four years of saving.
7. 07_photo	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	He's not a bad man.
8. 08_awake	Still	5.0s	cut	That's what makes it hard.
9. 09_dawn	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I didn't know who to ask.

10. 10_talking	Zoom out	5.0s	cut	So I started with the truth.
11. 99-free-end	Still	3.0s	cut	

Caption: Gambling doesn't smell like anything. No slurring, no bottles. It only shows up in the money — which is why the person who loves you is always the last to know. Free app, and part of it is for them. #lovinganaddict #gamblingrecovery #recoverysupport #lgbtqrecovery

EPISODE 2 · The Packages — two women

ROSA: *Latina woman, mid 30s, long dark hair usually tied back, small build.*

KAT: *white woman, late 30s, blonde bob, tall, freckles.*

Shopping's tell is the hiding, not the buying. Nobody hides a jumper. They hide *how many*. The tags left on, the bag brought in before you get home, "I've had this ages" — the lie is small enough that you let it go the first fifty times. That's what makes this one land: the partner isn't discovering a purchase, she's discovering how long she's been managed.

Also the cheapest of the four for search — **shopping addiction help, 880/mo, difficulty 41, tagged Build**, not too hard.

SHOT 1 — ROSA coming through an apartment door with grocery bags, KAT on the sofa looking up, warm evening light, ordinary *"She always got home before me."*

SHOT 2 — Close on a stack of unopened delivery boxes pushed into the back of a hall closet, coats hanging in front of them *"I found them looking for a coat."*

SHOT 3 — A wardrobe rail packed tight with clothes, close on several price tags still attached to sleeves *"Tags still on. All of them."*

SHOT 4 — KAT in a bedroom quickly pushing a shopping bag under the bed with her foot, half-turned toward the door, caught mid-motion *"I'd seen her do that before. I let it go."*

SHOT 5 — Close on a credit card statement on a kitchen counter under a lamp, a long column of small amounts, a hand flattening the page *"None of them were big. That's the thing."*

SHOT 6 — ROSA sitting on the edge of a bathtub in a bright bathroom, phone in hand, door closed, doing sums *"Small enough that I believed her every time."*

SHOT 7 — A framed photo of ROSA and KAT laughing at a kitchen table, warm and out of focus in the foreground of a dim room *"She's not greedy. She's not selfish."*

SHOT 8 — KAT asleep on the sofa under a blanket in lamplight, ROSA sitting on the floor beside her, awake, looking at nothing *"She's just scared of something she won't say."*

SHOT 9 — ROSA at a kitchen table at first light, laptop open, gray morning window behind her, tired, searching *"I didn't want to punish her. I wanted it to stop."*

SHOT 10 — Wide of a bright morning kitchen, both women sitting at the table facing each other, coffee between them, mid-conversation, unresolved but talking *"So I said it out loud."*

YouTube: When you find out how long they've been hiding it **TikTok:** None of them were big. That's the thing.

1. 01_door	Still	5.0s	cut	She always got home before me.
2. 02_boxes	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I found them looking for a coat.
3. 03_tags	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	Tags still on. All of them.
4. 04_bag	Still	5.0s	cut	I'd seen her do that before. I let it go.
5. 05_statement	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	None of them were big. That's the thing.
6. 06_bathroom	Still	5.0s	cut	Small enough that I believed her every time.

7. 07_photo	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	She's not greedy. She's not selfish.
8. 08_asleep	Still	5.0s	cut	She's just scared of something she won't say.
9. 09_dawn	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I didn't want to punish her. I wanted it to stop.
10. 10_kitchen	Zoom out	5.0s	cut	So I said it out loud.
11. 99-free-end	Still	3.0s	cut	

Caption: Nobody hides a sweater. They hide how many. Small enough that you believe them every time — until you add it up. There's a free app, and part of it is for the person doing the adding. #shoppingaddiction #lovinganaddict #recoverysupport #lgbtqrecovery

DROPPED (no episode number) · The Second Dinner — a man who binges, his wife

RAY: Black man, mid 40s, broad, short beard going gray, work shirt.

TAMMY: Black woman, early 40s, braids, glasses, cardigan.

Every article about binge eating is written for a woman. Men who do this have nowhere to read about themselves, so this flips the default the way episode 2 flips the couple. And it is the biggest winnable term you own — **how to stop binge eating, 9,900/mo, difficulty 37** — plus the only fully ad-safe lane in the file.

The tell is the disposal, not the eating. Wrappers under the seat. Eating in the car before he comes in so he can sit down to dinner like nothing happened. There is no substance to blame and no smell to catch — just a man being very careful, and a wife who notices he is never hungry.

SHOT 1 — TAMMY setting two plates on a kitchen table in warm evening light, RAY coming in from work, ordinary and easy *"He was never hungry at dinner."*

SHOT 2 — RAY sitting alone in a parked car outside a house at night, dome light off, eating quickly, looking at the front door *"I thought he'd eaten at work."*

SHOT 3 — Close on the footwell of a car, fast food wrappers pushed under the seat, a torn bag, shot from above *"I found them cleaning out the car."*

SHOT 4 — TAMMY standing very still by the open car door in daylight, keys in hand, looking down *"I sat in that car a long time."*

SHOT 5 — RAY at the kitchen table with a full plate in front of him, moving food around, TAMMY watching from the counter behind him, out of focus *"He wasn't hiding food. He was hiding himself."*

SHOT 6 — Close on RAY's hands resting on the edge of a kitchen counter at night, kitchen dark, fridge light on his face *"Ten minutes after everyone goes to bed."*

SHOT 7 — A framed photo of RAY and TAMMY at a family cookout, laughing, warm, slightly out of focus in a dim room *"He's not weak. He's not greedy."*

SHOT 8 — RAY asleep on top of the covers still in his work clothes, TAMMY sitting on the end of the bed, awake *"He's soothing something he's never said out loud."*

SHOT 9 — TAMMY at the kitchen table at first light, phone in hand, gray window behind her, searching *"Nothing I found was written for him."*

SHOT 10 — Wide of a bright morning kitchen, RAY and TAMMY sitting at the table facing each other, two coffees, mid-conversation *"So I stopped waiting for him to bring it up."*

YouTube: When it's your husband, and nothing you read is about him **TikTok:** He wasn't hiding food. He was hiding himself.

1. 01_dinner	Still	5.0s	cut	He was never hungry at dinner.
2. 02_car	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I thought he'd eaten at work.
3. 03_wrappers	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I found them cleaning out the car.
4. 04_stillness	Still	5.0s	cut	I sat in that car a long time.
5. 05_plate	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	He wasn't hiding food. He was hiding himself.
6. 06_fridge	Still	5.0s	cut	Ten minutes after everyone goes to bed.
7. 07_photo	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	He's not weak. He's not greedy.
8. 08_asleep	Still	5.0s	cut	He's soothing something he's never said out loud.
9. 09_dawn	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	Nothing I found was written for him.
10. 10_kitchen	Zoom out	5.0s	cut	So I stopped waiting for him to bring it up.
11. 99-free-end	Still	3.0s	cut	

Caption: Every article about this is written for a woman. He read all of them looking for himself and none of them were about him. There's a free app — the counter, the button for the ten minutes after everyone goes to bed, and a section for the person who noticed. #bingeeating #emotionaleating #recovery support #lovinganaddict

BENCHED (no episode number) · Right Here — a young couple, doomscrolling

Held back 14 Aug 2026. One doomscrolling episode in the lineup, and it went to Nia. Two people both on their phones is also the version everybody has seen.

AMARA: Black woman, late 20s, box braids, oversized sweatshirt.

JOSH: white man, late 20s, messy dark hair, hoodie, tired eyes.

The cheapest reach in the file — **how to stop doomscrolling, 1,600/mo, difficulty 24**, and the youngest audience you have. It is also the one addiction everybody watching is doing *while they watch it*, which is why it lands differently from the others.

The tell is time, not substance. Nothing is hidden and nothing is spent. Somebody is just gone — sitting right there and gone — and the person beside them can't name what they've lost, which is exactly why they never bring it up.

SHOT 1 — AMARA and JOSH on a sofa in a small apartment at night, sitting close, JOSH's face lit blue from a phone, AMARA looking at him *"He was right here."*

SHOT 2 — Close on AMARA's face in warm lamplight, mid-sentence, talking to someone off-frame *"I told him about my day."*

SHOT 3 — JOSH from AMARA's side, phone in hand, blue light on his face, nodding slightly, not looking up *"He said mm-hm in the right places."*

SHOT 4 — A dinner table with two plates, JOSH's phone face-up beside his fork, food half-eaten *"He couldn't tell me one thing I said."*

SHOT 5 — A dark bedroom, 2:47 on a bedside clock, JOSH's face lit by a phone, AMARA turned away asleep *"Two hours. Every night."*

SHOT 6 — Close on a phone screen at night showing an endless feed, blurred, a thumb mid-swipe *"He couldn't name one thing he'd read either."*

SHOT 7 — A photo on a fridge of AMARA and JOSH somewhere outdoors, laughing, sunlight, held on by a magnet *"He's not bored of me."*

SHOT 8 — JOSH asleep with the phone still in his open hand, screen on, AMARA awake beside him looking at the ceiling *"He's just somewhere he can't stop going."*

SHOT 9 — AMARA at a small kitchen table at first light, her own phone in her hand, catching herself, gray window *"And I do it too. That's the part nobody says."*

SHOT 10 — Bright morning, both of them on the sofa, phones face-down on the table between them, talking *"So we put them face-down and started again."*

YouTube: He was right here and he was gone **TikTok:** He said mm-hm in the right places.

1. 01_sofa	Still	5.0s	cut	He was right here.
2. 02_talking	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	I told him about my day.
3. 03_nodding	Still	5.0s	cut	He said mm-hm in the right places.
4. 04_dinner	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	He couldn't tell me one thing I said.
5. 05_clock	Still	5.0s	cut	Two hours. Every night.
6. 06_feed	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	He couldn't name one thing he'd read either.
7. 07_fridge	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	He's not bored of me.
8. 08_asleep	Still	5.0s	cut	He's just somewhere he can't stop going.
9. 09_dawn	Zoom in	5.0s	cut	And I do it too. That's the part nobody says.
10. 10_facedown	Zoom out	5.0s	cut	So we put them face-down and started again.
11. 99-free-end	Still	3.0s	cut	

Caption: Nothing gets hidden and nothing gets spent. Somebody's just gone — sitting right there and gone. Free app, and it counts whatever you're quitting. #doomscrolling #screentime #recoverysupport #phoneaddiction

Shot 9 is why this one travels. Every other episode has a clean line between the person using and the person who found out. This one admits the narrator does it too — which is true, and which is what makes a young audience send it to somebody instead of scrolling past.

STATE — 12 Aug 2026, end of day

Episodes 1 and 2 are built. Jacques assembled both in Studio this evening.

Cut lengths changed. The original 17-second blocks are superseded: at 1.3-1.5s a shot, **five of the ten captions could not be read in one pass** — timed against normal reading speed, and these captions are the whole story because there is no voiceover. The cuts are now:

- **30 seconds, all hard cuts** — for TikTok. Typed seconds equal finished seconds, because nothing is lost to blend overlap.
- **50 seconds, all blends** — for YouTube and Facebook. 55s raw; ten blends overlap 0.5s each (TRANS_DUR), so Studio reports 50.0 finished.

Two arithmetic traps that cost an hour, written down so they don't again:

- **Studio reports FINISHED length, not raw.** Every blend eats 0.5s. A block summing to 30 with four blends reads as 28.
- **"■ Cut on the beat" must be unticked on both episodes.** It rounds every shot up to a whole musical bar with a 1.5s floor, which flattens deliberate timing differences into one number.

RESOLVED 12 Aug, later: the four panels were re-rendered full-frame and episode 2 was rebuilt. The letterboxed version is superseded — if a future session finds two cuts of this episode, the full-frame one is the keeper.

(Original note, kept for the lesson:) **Episode 2's last four panels came back letterboxed** — widescreen pictures inside a vertical canvas, black bars top and bottom, where 1-6 were true full-frame. Jacques built with them as they are rather than wait. The re-render prompt is written and sits in the chat log; the fix is a ten-minute rebuild whenever Manus is generating images again, because the paste blocks don't change. **Shot 10 is the one that genuinely needs it** — the two women sit at opposite ends of a wide frame, so no vertical crop keeps both faces.

Music: written fresh this session rather than reused. Episode 1 is cold and tense (the piece is a man doing arithmetic he doesn't want to finish); episode 2 is warm (a woman who keeps forgiving). Three unusual options for episode 2 are

in the chat log — marimba and upright bass, Rhodes through tape delay, bowed vibraphone with sub bass — all instrumental, quiet, with real low end.

How to build any of them

Cuts, not blends. The rhythm is the point — it's the feeling of scrolling a statement. A blend softens it.

Still on the paper and the sleeping shots. Flat paper and a face in the dark both go mushy under a camera move.

Both run about **17 seconds**. Slightly over the window and worth it — the last two shots need room. Trim shot 1 to 1.0s if you want under 15.

Longer cut for YouTube and Facebook: same order, 4 seconds a shot, 40 seconds, blends instead of cuts, music underneath. Don't post that one to TikTok.

Tick "Made with AI" on every post — Studio appends it automatically on the AI presets.

The two lines never to rewrite

Each episode has a pair:

"He's not a bad man." / "That's what makes it hard."

"She's not greedy. She's not selfish." / "She's just scared of something she won't say."

Nothing in these pieces blames the person using, and nothing forgives them either. That pair is the entire emotional argument, it's what every partner recognizes, and no advert has ever said it. Everything else can be reworded.